Bow Valley College

Course Outline

ADDC2304

Advanced Counselling Skills for the Addiction Professional
Fall 2026 - Current

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Bow Valley College is situated in Treaty 7 territory. We honour the territories and Peoples of: the Blackfoot Confederacy, which includes the Siksika, Kainai, Piikani, and Amskapi Piikani (Blackfeet) First Nations; the Tsuut'ina First Nation; and the Îyâxe Nakoda, which includes the Goodstoney, Chiniki, and Bearspaw First Nations. We also acknowledge the historical Northwest Métis homeland and the Otipemisiwak Métis Government of Alberta, districts 4, 5, and 6 in Battle River territory.

ADDC2304 Advanced Counselling Skills for the Addiction Professional

COURSE DESCRIPTION

In this interactive course, students explore advanced interviewing and counselling techniques and practice-based skills for supporting addiction and recovery. There is a focus on deepening the student's applied practice and theoretical knowledge in a variety of counselling techniques, models of treatment, and treatment planning by engaging in experiential learning and developing critical thinking skills to enhance professional practice. This course takes a hands-on approach in which students examine how their values, beliefs, and feelings inform their understanding and practice as it relates to the helping relationship, ethics, special populations, and personal counselling approach.

REQUISITES	Complete all of the following • Complete the following courses ◦ HMSV1501 - Introduction to Counselling (3) ◦ ADDC1100 - Foundations of Addiction: A Multidimensional Approach (3) • Completed or concurrently enrolled in at least 2 of the following ◦ ADDC1300 - Intersections of Trauma, Addiction, and Healing (3) ◦ ADDC1500 - Assessment, Documentation, and Case Management in Addictions (3) ◦ ADDC1102 - Introduction to Pharmacology for Human Services (3)
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	3
HOURS	45
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	No
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	No

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong students. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that students acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Demonstrate advanced interviewing skills for intake and assessment in addiction settings by utilizing a strength-based approach that recognizes individuals' capacities, resources, and potential for growth.	1, 2, 4, 6, 8, 9
2	Apply advanced treatment planning skills by understanding the relationship between addiction and mental health through a biopsychosocial lens and trauma-informed perspective.	1, 2, 4, 7, 8, 9
3	Demonstrate advanced counselling techniques and competencies essential to building and maintaining relationships with clients, including specialized populations.	1, 2, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9
4	Apply advanced contemporary counselling techniques through trauma-informed and multicultural lenses.	1, 2, 4, 6, 7, 8
5	Examine counselling theories and models of addiction treatment and recovery support.	1, 2, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9
6	Evaluate personal beliefs and values related to addiction, recovery, ethics, boundaries, and standards of practice for professional and ethical practice.	2, 4, 6, 7, 8

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
1	Introduction, Course Overview, and Review of Micro Counselling Skills
2	Professional Identity: Boundaries, Self-Awareness, Values
3	Ethics in the Helping Professions and Multicultural Competency
4	Models of Addiction Treatment and Recovery and The Transtheoretical Model of Change
5	Advanced Interviewing Techniques - Motivational Interviewing
6	Advanced Counselling Techniques - Addressing Resistance, Goal Setting, and Exploring Issues
7	Counselling Theory and Techniques- Solution-Focused Approach and Strength-Based Approach
8	Counselling Theory and Techniques - Cognitive Behavioural Therapy, Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention
9	Advanced Assessment Frameworks, Intake Processes, and Interviewing
10	Advanced Treatment Planning
11	Reading Week
12	Working with Process-Based and Behavioural Addictions
13	Group Counselling
14	Group Counselling
15	Wrap Up and Celebration

ASSESSMENT

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	ASSESSMENT	WEIGHT
1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6	Reflective Journals	20%
1, 3, 4, 5, 6	Counselling Assignment(s)	25%
1, 2, 3, 4, 5	Case Study & Treatment Plan	25%
1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6	Learning Activities	30%

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A minimum grade of D is required to pass this course. However, a program may require a higher grade in this course to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

Please consult with the program area or contact the program chair for further details. A minimum Grade Point Average of 2.0 is required for graduation.

GRADING SCHEME

Grade	Percentage	Grade Point	Description
A+	95-100	4.0	Exceptional: superior knowledge of subject matter
A	90-94	4.0	Excellent: outstanding knowledge of subject matter
A-	85-89	3.67	
B+	80-84	3.33	
B	75-79	3.0	Very Good: knowledge of subject matter generally mastered
B-	70-74	2.67	
C+	67-69	2.33	
C	64-66	2.0	Satisfactory/Acceptable: knowledge of subject matter adequately mastered
C-	60-63	1.67	
D+	57-59	1.33	
D	50-56	1.0	Minimal Pass
F	Less than 50	0.0	Fail: an unsatisfactory performance

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Shebib, B. (2023). *Choices: Interviewing and Counselling Skills for Canadians* (8th Canadian ed.). Pearson.

Hegblom, T. et al. (2025) *Ethical Practice in Substance Use Disorder and Mental Health Counseling*. Open Access Ethical Practice in Co-Occurring Substance Use Disorder and Mental Health Counseling – Simple Book Publishing

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Students with documented disabilities (e.g., mental health diagnosis, learning disability, physical disability, etc.) may qualify for classroom and/or exam accommodations. The College can also assist students who may be experiencing difficulties with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. Students who need academic and exam accommodations based on other protected grounds may also make those requests.
It is the student's responsibility to request academic accommodations. Students are encouraged to contact Accessibility Services as early as possible.

Visit: Learner Success Services- 1st floor south campus
Contact: accessibility@bowvalleycollege.ca or 403-410-1440
BVC Central: Accessibility Services

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Student Code of Conduct (500-1-1), Student Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1- 10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13).
Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by students is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Academic Integrity:

At Bow Valley College, we value academic integrity. This means everyone at the college, including students, faculty, and staff, follow principles that foster ethical and truthful ways of being in their work and studies. The college is committed to integrity being infused in all aspects of work and studies. It is important to act with integrity in everything you do at the college. The values you practice at the college are the same values that will inform and guide your career. If someone breaks from the principles that are in agreement with academic integrity policy, the college is committed to carefully investigating and fairly handling any issues related to academic integrity and academic misconduct.

Academic misconduct is acting in such a way as to give yourself or others an unfair academic advantage or disadvantage. Examples of this can include:

- Plagiarism
- Cheating on tests or exams
- Tampering with or falsifying any grades or documents
- Sharing assignments or exam information with others
- Aiding others in dishonest acts
- Using artificial intelligence in graded work without the explicit consent of the instructor
- Recording anything in the classroom or other instructional area without permission

Breaking from the principles that guide academic integrity can lead to educative interventions and/or punitive measures. It is the student's responsibility to review the Academic Integrity Policy. Please review the following resources:

- Academic Integrity Policy Summary
- Academic Integrity Policy
- Academic Integrity Procedure

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student work. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where either the course instructor, a representative of Bow Valley College, or a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;

b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, https://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/academic-calendar.
Students are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements. You may use the recordings only for educational purposes. You must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission. Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 4 (c) of the Protection of Privacy Act, Alberta (POPA) to deliver academic programming, support student flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. Bow Valley College uses automated systems to generate content and make decisions, recommendations and predictions, and your personal information may be included in these automated systems.
Your personal information will be used and disclosed in accordance with sections 12 and 13 of POPA and protected in accordance with section 10 of POPA. If you have any questions about the collection, use, disclosure or protection of personal information, please contact the Access and Privacy Officer at privacy@bowvalleycollege.ca.